

The Get-Paid Playbook

Three short playbooks to help you invoice professionally, get paid faster, and stay compliant — wherever your clients are.

Playbook 1 — The 5-Minute Professional Invoice

Why it matters: Invoices that look unprofessional get paid 2–3x slower. Clients (especially finance teams) prioritize invoices that are easy to read, easy to verify, and easy to process.

The 9 fields every invoice must have

- 1 The word **“Invoice”** clearly at the top
- 2 A **unique invoice number** (sequential, e.g., INV-2026-001)
- 3 **Issue date** and **due date** (not just “due on receipt”)
- 4 **Your full business details:** legal name, address, tax ID / VAT / GST number
- 5 **Client’s full billing details:** legal entity name, address, tax ID where required
- 6 **Itemized line items:** description, quantity, unit price, line total
- 7 **Subtotal, tax (with rate), and total** in the correct currency
- 8 **Payment instructions:** bank details, payment link, accepted methods
- 9 **Payment terms:** “Net 14”, “Net 30”, late fee policy if any

Pro tips that get you paid faster

- Send invoices the **same day** the work is approved — every day of delay is a day added to your payment cycle.
- Use **Net 14** instead of Net 30 by default. Most clients pay on the day they receive the invoice anyway; shorter terms anchor expectations.
- Add a **“Pay now”** link, not just bank details. Friction is the #1 reason invoices sit unpaid.
- Reference the **PO number or project name** in the invoice number or notes — finance teams can’t process invoices they can’t match.

Playbook 2 — The Polite Follow-Up Sequence

Why it matters: 60%+ of late payments are not refusals — they're forgotten. A consistent, professional follow-up cadence recovers most of them without damaging the relationship.

3 days BEFORE due date — friendly nudge

Subject: Heads up — invoice INV-2026-001 due Friday

Hi [Name], just a quick reminder that invoice INV-2026-001 (\$X) is due on [date]. You can pay directly here: [link]. Let me know if anything's needed on my end. Thanks!

On the due date — neutral reminder

Subject: Invoice INV-2026-001 due today

Hi [Name], invoice INV-2026-001 for \$X is due today. Payment link: [link]. If it's already in motion, please ignore this. Thank you!

3 days overdue — direct but warm

Subject: Invoice INV-2026-001 — quick check

Hi [Name], invoice INV-2026-001 was due on [date] and I haven't seen payment land yet. Could you confirm where it is in your process, or pay here: [link]? Happy to help if there's anything blocking it.

7 days overdue — escalate

Subject: Invoice INV-2026-001 — please confirm

Hi [Name], following up again on invoice INV-2026-001 (now 7 days overdue). Could you let me know the expected payment date? If there's an issue with the invoice, I'd like to resolve it this week.

14 days overdue — formal

Subject: Action required: invoice INV-2026-001 (14 days overdue)

Hi [Name], invoice INV-2026-001 is now 14 days overdue. Per the agreed terms, a late fee of [%] now applies. Please confirm payment by [date] to avoid further action.

Pro tip: Automate steps 1–4 so you only have to manually handle step 5. Invoicemonk's automated reminders do exactly this.

Playbook 3 — Getting Paid Across Borders Without Losing 8% to Fees

Why it matters: A typical international wire from a US client to a freelancer in NG/IN/PH loses 4–8% to FX markup, intermediary bank fees, and receiving bank charges. On a \$5,000 invoice, that's \$200–\$400 — gone.

The 4 rules of international invoicing

- 1 Invoice in the client's currency, not yours.** Clients are 3x more likely to pay quickly when they don't have to think about FX. You absorb the conversion on your side, where you control the rate.
- 2 Avoid SWIFT wires when you can.** A SWIFT transfer often costs \$25–\$50 in sender fees + \$15–\$30 in receiving fees + 2–4% FX markup. Use Wise, Payoneer, or local rails (UPI for India, Pix for Brazil, Instant EFT for South Africa) where possible.
- 3 Always include both your local and international payment options** on the invoice. Give the client the cheapest option *for them*, and they'll use it.
- 4 Check the corridor before quoting.** A \$5,000 USD→NGN payment via Wise vs. SWIFT can differ by \$300+. Use Invoicemonk's International Payment Fee Calculator before agreeing on a payment method.

Quick reference — best rails by corridor

Corridor	Best rail
US → India	Wise or direct INR via Payoneer
EU → Nigeria	Wise USD → domestic, or Grey
UK → Philippines	Wise GBP → PHP
US → Brazil	Wise USD → BRL via Pix
Anywhere → South Africa	Wise or PayPal Business (small amounts)

Ready to put this into practice?

Invoicemonk does all of this for you — professional invoices, automated reminders, multi-currency, and the lowest-fee payment rails — on a free-forever plan.

Create your free account → app.invoicemonk.com